



Recreating 3D from 2D

A clever algorithm created by AI researcher in Berkeley can recreate tiny 2D images as 3D objects. <http://dgit.in/2Dand3D>



Johnson & Johnson law suit

An LA jury awarded \$417M to a woman who said she got cancer from talc present in Johnson & Johnson baby powder. <http://dgit.in/417johnson>

HP Pavilion x360 14-ba073TX

Refined hybrid

This year HP is bundling HP's digital pen (stylus) along with the 14-inch variants. However that is something the competition is also offering and hence the new x360 stands on even grounds with its competitors.

This laptop is not as lightweight as HP's Spectre, but it is pretty much at par with the competition.



Price
₹72,900

Design and build

The laptop is now slightly slimmer than its previous iteration even with a dedicated GPU inside.

However, for the asking price, instead of an all metal chassis, the HP x360 gets by with same high quality plastic material we got the last time. The new 360 degree rotating hinge offers decent resistance and remains in place while typing or watching a movie. The display wobbles slightly when you use the touch screen, but it is not very distracting and is better than what HP offered the last time.

Display and input

The display's colour saturation is decent, so are the viewing angles. The touch response is quite good and accurate for the most part. As this is an x360, the display can be rotated completely and you can use it as tablet, but with a weight of 1.7 kgs, we won't recommend you to use it as one.

The bundled pen can be used to navigate around the laptop and it works well most of the times. We faced a little bit of irregularity with the stylus and tried reproducing the issue, but it was too random to figure out the culprit. It could easily be the input lag between the stylus and the pen, but it might just be a Windows Ink issue. That being said, it is not a deterrent for



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the average buyer.

As for the keyboard HP hasn't changed the appearance and layout from last year. Hence, the function keys sitting in the top row are half the size of the normal keys, making them look distinctive and easy to identify. That being said, the smaller keys take some time to adjust to.

The touchpad on the other hand is smooth and works without any issues. The left and right keys require ample effort and depress down with a familiar click.

Performance

The Intel Core i5-7200U is more than capable of handling all big and small tasks alike and the 8 GB of RAM is more than enough to handle multiple tasks at any given time. We used the machine with variable workloads, including one time when we were copying a large data file in the background, had more than a dozen tabs open in chrome and were playing Dota 2 at the same time at medium settings.

On the same note, Dota 2 runs at high settings in 1080p pushing more than 60fps at all times.

What is a little concerning though, is that the laptop gets hot very quickly above the keyboard, especially on the left side, right above the exhaust, while gaming. Now, the heat is not an issue

as your hands won't be resting anywhere near the hot zones.

We also need to address the audio quality of the laptop, which is catered to by a B&O optimised speaker system. It is fairly loud and manages to reproduce most details, apart from the bass, which still remains the achilles heel for most laptop speakers.

Battery

Lastly, using the laptop as a daily driver, we were able to get about 7-8 hours of usage from it, which is quite impressive. We kept brightness at 100 percent most of the time, during our test period. The battery life only varied when we played video games or watched movies on the machine. In our standard PCMark 8 Work battery test, which comprises of browsing, writing, spreadsheet and video chat tests, the laptop scored 2 hours and 46 minutes, which is slightly better than the category average.

Bottomline

Overall, we think the HP Pavilion x360 14 ba-073TX is a refined version of last year's x360. It offers a decent build, battery life as well as reliable performance. It might not be as well equipped as other non-hybrid laptops in the same price, but it does offer a slightly more powerful resume. In addition, the bundled pen (stylus) by HP is a boon. Lenovo's Yoga 520S is the only competitor and is the more affordable but lacks the graphics performance.

—Hardik Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: Intel® Core™ i5-7200U | GPU: NVIDIA GeForce 940MX
2 GB | RAM: 8GB DDR4 RAM @ 2133 MHz | OS: Windows 10
| BATTERY: 3-cell, 41 Wh Li-ion | I/O: 1 HDMI; 1 headphone/microphone combo; 1 USB 3.1 Type-C™ Gen 1 (Data up to 5 Gb/s); 2 USB 3.1 Gen 1 (Data transfer only).

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